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Changes to Visa Applications Outside Your Country of Residence

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International Student Engagement

Provides updates from the US Department of State regarding applying for nonimmigrant visas

in third countries, effective 9/6/2025.

An update issued September 6, 2025 by the U.S. Department of State may affect visa renewals for students attempting to renew their visa outside their home country. This update pertains to students whose current F-1 visas have expired or will expire while traveling or studying abroad.

The update states that, **effective immediately:**

- Applicants for U.S. nonimmigrant visas (NIV) should schedule their visa interview appointments at the U.S. Embassy or Consulate **in their country of nationality or residence***
- Nationals of countries where the U.S. government is not conducting routine nonimmigrant visa operations **must apply at the designated embassy or consulate** (the option to apply in any third country has been eliminated)**,** unless their residence* is elsewhere

**It is unclear if studying abroad will be considered "residence" for purposes of being able to apply in the study abroad host country, and may vary by consular post.*

Recommendations:

- If you will need to renew your visa at some point in the future, be aware of this new practice and plan accordingly
- If you have future plans to study abroad and will need to renew your visa, please consider this change while making your plans. Because it is unclear whether study abroad students will be allowed to renew in their host country, we encourage you to contact the US embassy or consulate in your host country very early to inquire about this possibility and be prepared to travel to your home country/designated location to renew, if necessary

ISE and OEAA are monitoring this closely. We will provide updates if more information, clarity, or changes are available. In the meantime, if you have questions or want to talk through specific scenarios, feel free to connect with an ISE or OEAA team member.

Discussion

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